

Northern Virginia Sun

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Tuesday, November 15, 1966

Should Papers Avoid Fights

This question was asked of us: "Should a newspaper deal with controversial subject?" Our answer is a quick one — yes.

A newspaper is a privately owned institution but it is oriented to the public. Regardless of the private ownership any American newspaper has a public responsibility. The responsibility includes the preaching of the American concepts, the right of the individual, honesty in government, dedication of the interests of all of the people and the sponsorship of those things which are to the good of the people as a whole. A newspaper has the obligation to seek to make its community a better place in which to live. Thus it is impossible to avoid controversial issues. The newspaper must encourage the things that are in the interest of the city, county, state and nation and conversely oppose those things which curtail these interests.

Despite the fact that a newspaper may be privately owned it should not uphold those things which exclusively serve its own interests. For example, a newspaper which opposes the aroused passions of the people in time of stress will find that it can make itself momentarily unpopular through such opposition. When obstructionists seek to obstruct progress it follows that the promotion of progress creates the disenchantment of the obstructionists.

But there is a rewarding fact concerning this matter of controversy. It is generally recognized that a newspaper can not promote

the best interests of the people of this country through a policy of conformity. Conformity is the easy way for the moment but it does not command respect in the long run. With time even the conformists recognize that the spineless acceptance of conformity is shortsighted, even wicked.

A respected newspaper usually is one that is willing to participate in controversy with the will to see the best interests of the town or country upheld. The great newspapers of the nation are the ones which are forthright editorially. The newspapers which meekly go along with any proposition with the purpose of offending no one usually are regarded as weak newspapers.

Someone could ask, "What about the newspaper which have no commanding editorial policy but which make big profits from their large volume of advertising?" There are some American newspaper organizations in this category. But actually they are profit-making organizations, not respected newspapers as such.

There are no great newspapers in Red China, Castro's Cuba or in the Soviet Union. The proof of this charge is easy. Freedom of information is not the goal in these countries. But in America the purpose of newspaper must be to keep people informed and to provide some editorial guidance. No newspaper can do this if its staff is unwilling to: (1) Become involved in controversy, (2) offend someone if it is necessary or (3) to refuse to use the editorial and news pages to serve personal goals for privileged interests.

Students Swamp Colleges

There are, according to preliminary enrollment reports, possibly as many as 6.45 million students in American colleges and universities this fall.

The announcement comes from Dr. Garland G. Parker, University of Cincinnati statistician, who annually makes a detailed collegiate enrollment study for the Journal School and Society.

Sophomore and junior enrollments are the largest in history as the large lumps of "gigantic" freshman classes of the last two years move further along in the educational esophagus.

This year's freshman enrollment is down slightly — about 2.5 per

cent — from last year, largely because of the birthrate decline in 1948 and the impact of Selective Service.

The next two freshman classes will not increase significantly over this year, says Dean Parker, giving the schools a chance to cope with the inordinately large student body in the upper classes.

Even so, he says, "the accommodation of such a mass of students will levy a high toll on the nation's academic, physical and financial resources in the next two years."

Thereafter, freshman enrollments will again begin to climb, he warns.

Conjugal Visits Would Help

Civilized society shows special concern for the family. Not all families receive adequate attention.

We reflect today on the families of men in state and federal prisons. Separation of wives from their husbands makes survival of these family units precarious indeed.

Clinton T. Duffy, a former prison warden, recently discussed this subject in The Atlanta Constitution. He praised Mississippi for allowing conjugal visits to married prisoners. Warden Duffy said that years of celibacy in prison render a man unfit to resume normal family life. Wives and children

suffers because the ex-convicts frequently return to their old criminal habits.

It may be that the other 49 states and the federal government do not provide for conjugal visits because they fear embarrassment. Mississippi, however, manages successfully. Every state has a duty to protect families.

A reasonable way to keep families together and prevent future trouble is to allow husbands and wives to continue their relationship approved by the state under the marriage contract.

Warden Duffy's frank discussion of a taboo subject may help legislators approve a more enlightened public policy.



"Would you believe it? They're already scheming and plotting for the '68 elections!"



National Window

Plan to Tap Oil Reserves

A new gold rush has begun in Canada. The world's largest known deposits of black gold — oil — will soon be tapped in the already booming province of Alberta.

The oil-drenched sands along the Athabasca River have been a secret for two centuries, but commercial development has been stymied because of the excessive cost of extracting oil from sand.

Next year, however, a \$230 million processing plant will use new techniques to exploit an oozing black oilfield the size of Maine. Experts estimate that the Athabasca "tar sands" hold perhaps 600 million barrels of oil — more than the rest of the world's proven reserves combined.

Ever since the Leduc oil well gushed 19 years ago, Alberta has been profitably tapping its vast mineral resources, the National Geographic Society says.

Some 12,000 operating oil wells and 3,000 natural gas wells already have brought the western prairie province more than a billion dollars in royalties. The provincial government owns 87 per cent of all mineral rights.

Appropriately, the capital, Edmonton, stands above a vast underground pool of oil and natural gas. Edmontonians joke that the water supply is so permeated by natural gas that you can light the kitchen faucets.

Fabulous mineral resources are only part of the prosperity story, however. Texas size Alberta is a land that looks and behaves like the western United States — only more so.

"Alberta enjoys a balanced boom because the four pillars of our economy — farming, construction, mining and manufacturing — each contribute roughly a quarter of the province's total income," explains a government economist.

Thanks to foot-thick black topsoil, Albertan farmers produce a fourth of Canada's beef, mutton, wheat, and oats.

Giant pulp and paper mills are going up amid vast timber resources and plentiful water.

Scarcely more than a trading post 60 years ago, Edmonton is now Canada's largest inland city west of the Great Lakes. Its population — 375,000 — has doubled in the last decade, making it the nation's fastest growing metropolis.

Edmontonians enjoy Canada's first public planetarium, a magnificent auditorium, and glass-walled skyscrapers with revolving rooftop restaurants. Farsighted city officials have set aside 15 acres of parkland for every 1,000 citizens.

Calgary, the province's second largest city, suggests Dallas, Houston, or Tulsa. Some 400 oil companies have their head offices in this former town, which now boasts an art center, auditorium, elegant department stores, and Canada's biggest zoo.

Scenic beauty is a major resource in Alberta. In Banff and Jasper National Parks, tourists climb snow-capped peaks and fish in alpine lakes. More than a score of mountains rise higher than 10,000 feet, thus the region's sobriquet, "Fifty Switzerlands in One."

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Letters to the Editor

The SUN welcomes letters from its readers, but such letters must be signed in order to be considered for publication. Names of letter writers will be withheld from publication, or pseudonyms used upon request. Please include complete address and telephone number, so that authorship of the letter may be confirmed.

Conservatives Showed Strength

Editor, the SUN:
As a member of the Virginia Conservative Party, I want to thank all those who took part and also those who voted for our candidates. I cannot express my thoughts of other members but my purpose was accomplished. Our influence was felt. It cannot be measured in numbers. We put on a show of an unknown strength and the major candidates began sounding more sensible instead of the usual me-tooism.

When Republicans try to sound like Democrats, people do not go to the polls and I believe there was a heavy vote because people came to the polls to save the Republican Party from self-destruction. We need a two-party system and that is what the people are demanding and it took a few of us to stick our necks out and put on a threat of destroying a party in order to wake up the people from their apathy.

Since none of us wanted any personal gain and wanted only to be free of dictatorial bureaucratic government, we are all pleased at the result of the election. Whether the third party continues or is revived in 1968, depends upon whether the Virginia senators and congressmen resist socialism or go along with it.

GEORGE A. BIRDSALL
Annandale

Help New Breed Says Old Gunny

Editor, the SUN:
I am writing this letter not only for my son but for all the boys who enlisted as a group while at Washington - Lee High School in the United States Marine Corps.

These five boys enlisted in May 1966 prior to graduation with a 120-day delay, which meant they reported to Parris Island, S. C., at the Marine Corps Recruit Depot on Sept. 7, 1966.

The other day my wife and I drove to Parris Island to see these boys have their final review as recruits and it was a real pleasure for me, having over 25 years regular and reserve duty in the Marine Corps.

In enlisted for four more years in the Reserve because I felt it the thing I could do to show these boys that we old-timers are behind them in their duty to our country.

I served in four combat invasions with the First Marine Division in the Pacific in WW II. I feel we of the Old Breed should do anything we can to help the New Breed.

These boys were asked when they first reported to Parris Island the name of their hometown and they gave the Northern Virginia SUN.

In view of this fact I feel you could advise the readers of these boys and I am sure they would appreciate it. They are now at Camp Lejeune taking their intensive training prior to assignment to their first duty stations.

Pvt. Gary P. Harris, 1043 N. Nelson St.

Pvt. Douglas Pennington, 1903 N. Randolph St.

Pvt. Roger Suter, 508 N. Highland St.

Pvt. Kevin Williams, 5841 N. 15th St.

Pvt. Dennis Enck, 4309 N. Pershing Drive, who will complete recruit training the first week in December.

GySgt. GEORGE C. HARRIS
Arlington

CCSI Requests Full Support

Editor, the SUN:

The following letter has been sent to Ned R. Thomas, 3411 Arlington Blvd.

Dear Mr. Thomas:

Our dynamic world demands that Arlington students acquire more skills and a greater depth of preparation than ever before. Arlington's school system faces a continuing challenge to meet the needs of its students. The Citizens' Committee for School Improvement hopes you and all County Board members will give your full support in order to meet this challenge.

CCSI's primary concern always has been the establishment of as fine a school system as Arlington's resources permit. CCSI may be counted upon to continue to strive for this objective, and hopes to work with all of you toward this end.

PAUL E. NELSON JR.
Chairman, CCSI
Arlington

Allen-Scott Report

Blames Slowdown On Bottlenecks

By ROBERT S. ALLEN
and PAUL SCOTT



Mr. Allen

An important reason for the slowdown in the expansion of U.S. forces in Viet Nam is numerous logistic bottlenecks.

President Johnson approved Defense Secretary McNamara's recommendation for the stretch-out — as the Joint Chiefs of Staff are calling it — after being informed that Viet Nam docking and shipping facilities are taxed to their limits.

Reports given the President during his recent Viet Nam visit warned that 425,000 troops are the top number that can be adequately supplied for months to come because of so-far-unsolvable logistic complexities.

This number is approximately 75,000 less than what General Westmoreland, commander in Viet Nam, considers necessary to mount a victory drive. At present there are 334,000 American troops there.

In the strategy talks at Cam Ranh Bay and Manila, General Westmoreland told the President that under present "Viet Nam ground rules", a half million U.S. troops would be needed to win and secure the country. Also, the fighting would take five years.

This period could be reduced to around one year, Westmoreland believes, if a naval and air blockade is imposed on North Viet Nam and unrestricted bombing authorized against all "military targets."

Defense authorities who made the Viet Nam trip with the President report he was visibly distressed by his inspection of and detailed information on the logistic bottlenecks — which he thought had been cleared up months ago.

Approximately 150 American-flag freighters were backed up at the three main South Viet Nam ports — at an individual cost of \$4,500 a day to the government — waiting to unload military supplies.

At Cam Ranh Bay 37 vessels were waiting to discharge cargoes when the President arrived. From the air, he could see another 60 anchored off Vung Tau (Cape Saint Jacques) near the mouth of the Saigon River) waiting to dock and unload.

Numerous other ships were anchored near Da Nang awaiting word to move in and discharge cargoes. In Manila the President witnessed Viet Nam-bound cargo being trans-loaded from large U.S. vessels to smaller coastal freighters for the trip to Saigon. This was being done, the President was informed, in order not to tie up the larger ships by lengthy delays in waiting for berths in Viet Nam.

Officials accompanying the President relate he displayed

open anger when told that docking facilities are so scarce in Viet Nam that nine ammunition ships — double the number permitted under safety rules — were being unloaded at the same time at the so-called "red label" discharge point near Saigon.

In a briefing at this place, the President was told that as a result of this extremely crowded condition, an explosion on one of these ammunition vessels almost certainly would cause the destruction of all of them.

Immediately following the President's return from this gravely disturbing first-hand inspection, he ordered a review of the entire logistic situation in Viet Nam.

At one session the President sternly ordered Defense and other officials. "From here on out I want everyone to concentrate on clearing up these bottlenecks. They are to be given the highest priority forthwith."

Later, when informed it would be impossible to considerably improve this situation before the middle of next year, the President decided there was no alternative but to agree to Defense Secretary McNamara's recommendation for a slowdown in the expansion of U.S. forces there.

Despite the Republicans' sweeping election victories, President Johnson apparently is seriously considering proposing a multi-billion dollar Marshall Plan for Asia — after peace is restored in Viet Nam.

For this purpose the Maritime Commission has been directed to make a study of the number of ships that would be required to carry out such a gigantic aid program.

Since the U.S. now has only around 175 dry cargo and tanker vessels with more than five years of service left in them, the Maritime Commission's report could be the groundwork for a vast new government-subsidized shipbuilding program.

When the Marshall Plan for World War II, the U.S. put into service hundreds of war-built ships. In the 20 years since then, most of them have been junked.

Boris Klosson, the State Department official who had a hand in clearing the way for Lee Harvey Oswald's return from Russia, has been given a new job.

In addition to serving as the department's director of Soviet and Eastern European exchange programs, Klosson has been named to the foreign service selection committee.

Inside Labor

VanArsdale, Man Behind Rocky

By VICTOR RIESEL



Mr. Riesel

NEW YORK — A labor leader by name of Harry VanArsdale Jr. is one of the town's natural nocturnal noises. He never sleeps. In the recent gubernatorial campaign he slept even less. He was for "Rocky" all the way. And with him were the men of labor's substance who methodically leave the headlines to the flashier intellectual types.

It was to these men of the crafts that Nelson Rockefeller had turned for a base when the organized Conservatives and professional Liberals had left him. And it was these methodical, non-Rutherfordian men who turned "Rocky" into a presidential hopeful. How?

There has been no labor machine like it since the first weavers. They did it with the proletariat for Rockefeller, grandson of John D. and scion of Chase Manhattan.

They did it with hackles for Rocky, doormen for Rocky, streetcleaners for Rocky, bartenders for Rocky, kitchen cleaners for Rocky, electricians for Rocky, carpenters for Rocky — right on through the workers of hand as well as brain.

They started a year ago under VanArsdale's leadership and — as this column pointed out then — it was inevitable that they would roll up almost half a million vote majority.

It all now is a new force woven around a "labor Republican." Or, as the coffee house crowd would say, it is a new beginning. It is the pattern Rockefeller Republicans will use in other states to win the big city votes.

And a fascinating pattern it is. Look, for example, at the Labor Committee for Rockefeller. Its treasurer is Mike Sampson, leader of the public utility workers. Working with VanArsdale, head of the million-member Central Labor Council, "Mike" raised the money for one of Rockefeller's most effective half-hour TV shows. And they did not do it with new dime.

Then they rounded up a panel of men known as powerhouses to the insiders but unknown to the public. However, what matter. These men are known to their thousands on thousands of followers: the carpenters' Charles Johnson; the construction unions' Pete Brennan; the

sanitation workers' John De Lury; the operating engineers' Dick Nolan; the actors' Fred O'Neal, Negro head of Equity, and Mike and Harry.

Then they sat around with "Nelson" clear-eyed before the camera's red eyes and filmed a question session. It was effective.

Then they bought the time for last minute broadcasts. But what about an audience? On the final Saturday, they had their troops distribute hundreds of thousands of leaflets, plugging the show at subway stations and shopping centers. No other labor candidate between the Brooklyn and the Golden Gate Bridges could match this.

But you ain't seen nothing yet. Pete Brennan's building unions hit every construction job in the state with Rocky posters. Everybody was reminded that the Rockefeller had made work for the trades away back in the thirties when nobody was building except the Rockefeller in their Center.

And the governor himself made certain to remind them that the family had been pretty good patrons. Said he, "we have never had one day of strikes that have tied up Rockefeller Center since the 1930's."

And the construction haulers' trucks got the posters up, too. Building service unions had their elevator men slip literature into thousands of apartments.

Bartenders (Local 15) mixed politics with drinks. A caller at the giant New York taxi drivers' union was told politely to come back: "We have a campaign on." What campaign? The Rocky campaign.

In every big garage, the militant hackles of the 20,000-member Taxi Drivers' Union cranked up each shift with "Rocky for Governor" literature. It so happens that Harry VanArsdale is the newly elected president of Taxi Drivers Local 3036. This makes it a 58-hour day, since he also leads the 32,000-member Local 3, Electrical Brotherhood one of the most powerful in the land.

Street cleaners mopped up the districts with special steward systems which — matched only by Local 3's network — are the most amazing in the land. They have a block by block, family by family, precinct by precinct contact apparatus.